

How to Use L5-Swagger for Laravel API Documentation

Developers often skip documentation—but with **L5-Swagger**, your Laravel APIs can have *live, interactive, always-updated docs* that your whole team (and future you!) will love.

This guide shows you how to install, configure, and troubleshoot Swagger in Laravel in just a few steps.

What is L5-Swagger?

L5-Swagger is a Laravel wrapper for Swagger-PHP and Swagger-UI. It scans your controllers for *OpenAPI annotations* and automatically builds interactive API documentation.

Setup in 4 Steps

1. Install Package

```
composer require darkaonline/l5-swagger
```

2. Publish Config

```
php artisan vendor:publish --provider="L5Swagger\L5SwaggerServiceProvider"
```

3. Add Annotations

At minimum, include `@OA\Info()`:

```
/**
 * @OA\Info(
 *   title="My API Docs",
 *   version="1.0.0"
 * )
```

*/

4. Generate Docs

```
php artisan l5-swagger:generate
```

Then visit `/api/documentation` in your browser.

Common Pitfalls

⚠️ **Missing @OA\Info()** → Docs won't build at all.

⚠️ **No annotated routes** → Nothing will show up.

💡 Check your `config/l5-swagger.php` to ensure annotation paths (controllers, models) are correct.

🚀 Want the *full guide* with real examples, fixes & screenshots?

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